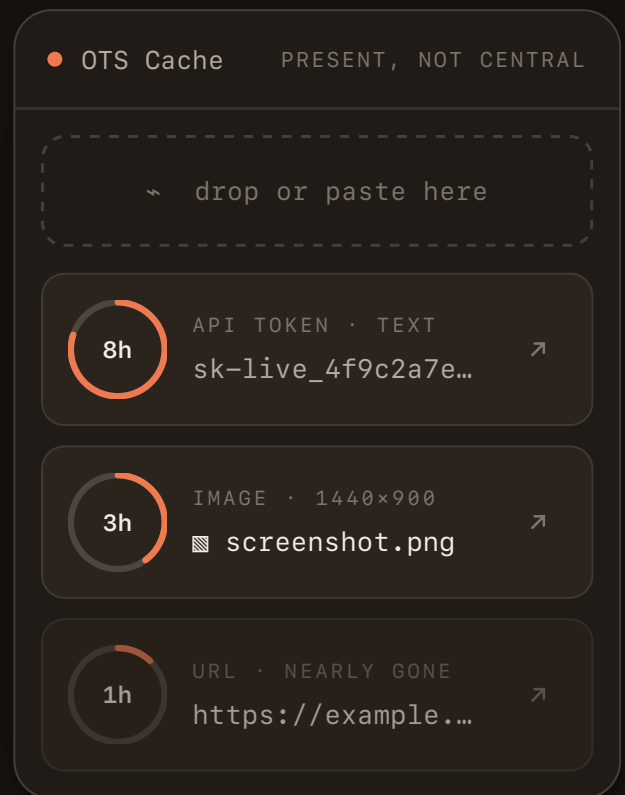


MILESTONE 1 · PROBLEM SPACE

An *L1/L2* cache for content in transit.

The macOS clipboard is a single volatile register: copy something new and the last thing is gone. The market's answer — clipboard history — keeps *everything, forever*, quietly hoarding every password and 2FA code you ever copied.

We go the other way. A small, bounded set of slots that hold your working set `right now` and then evict themselves. Forgetting is the resting state.

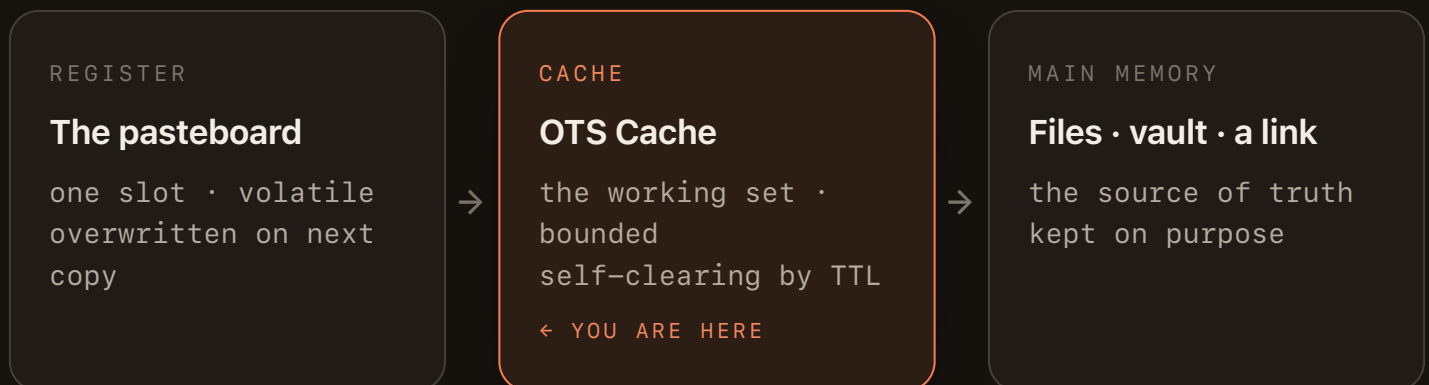


SleeperCell — state over content ·
click the label to cycle its TTL

THE METAPHOR, MADE LITERAL

It's not a clipboard app. It's the missing layer of the hierarchy.

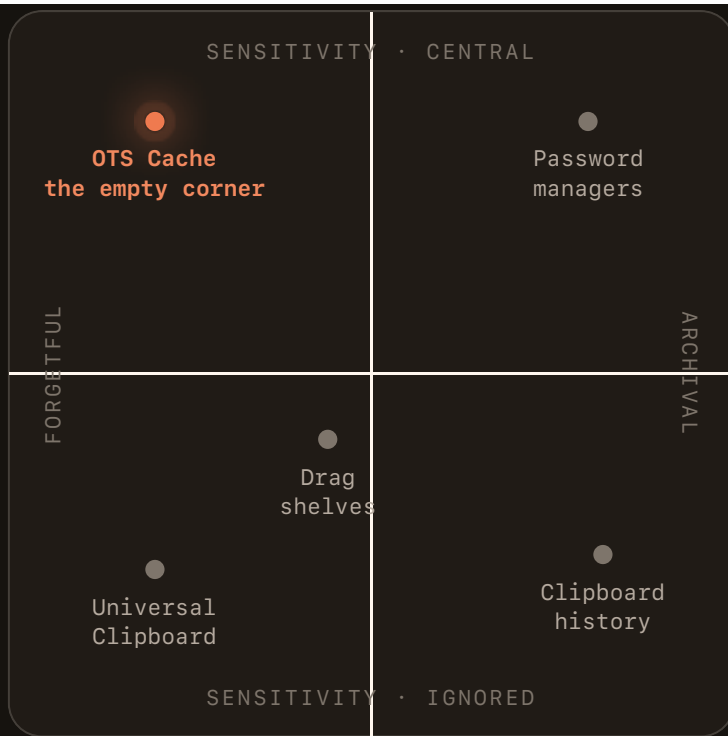
Every property of a good cache is a design law here: bounded capacity is a feature, eviction is automatic, and it is never the source of truth — which is exactly why aggressive expiry is safe.



A cache line can vanish and nothing breaks — you re-copy from the origin. That is the permission slip for forgetting.

WHERE WE SIT

Everyone else



lives in three corners. The fourth is open.

Clipboard managers optimise for recall and persist the sensitive. Shelves like Yoink get the quiet, temporary interaction right but carry no clock and no conscience. Vaults are the opposite end of the hierarchy entirely.

A bounded, self-clearing, ambient buffer for sensitive content in transit – with a one-gesture bridge to secure, one-time sharing.

Forgetting is free. Keeping costs a click.

THE PRINCIPLE THAT GIVES EXPIRY TEETH

THE ETHOS

Tie-breakers, not features.

When two designs are otherwise reasonable, the one that honours more of these wins.

01

Ephemeral by default

Expiry is the resting state; permanence is the exception that must be requested.

02

Content plays second fiddle

The star is the state — time, security, transit. Cells preview content; they never edit it.

03

Present, not central

An ambient panel that's there on a glance and gone otherwise. It never steals keyboard focus.

04

Frugal on every axis

Small in memory, disk, battery, pixels, and cognition. Native Rust, not a browser in a trench coat.

05

Accessible from commit one

Full keyboard control; the countdown never leans on colour or motion alone.

06

No baggage

Nothing to name, tag, organise, or clean up. It never asks to be maintained.

TIME IS THE PRIMARY INTERFACE

One label, on every cell, one click from adjustment.

7d →

3d →

24h →

8h →

3h →

1h ↺

The default rests **short** – hours, not days – so the honest common case evaporates on its own. The rare keeper is promoted **up** the ladder, one deliberate step at a time.

MILESTONE 1 · DELIVERABLE

README.md · docs/00-problem-space.md

branch: claude/rust-desktop-app-spec-65voi9

Primary job: local ephemeral buffer – **no account, offline, forever.**

Secondary job: promote to a Onetime Secret link via the v3 **conceal** API.

Auth path: Basic (extid + API token) today → PASETO next.